



CERTIFICATION FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS

These questions and answers are based upon current laws and regulations and are subject to change by the State Board of Education and/or the Professional Standards and Teacher Education Board.

General FAQ

Renewal FAQ

Advanced Professional Certificate FAQ

OTHER FAQ (add endorsement, ancillary credits, senior exemption, and certificate copies)

TEACH Portal FAQ

GENERAL FAQ

What type of certificates are available in Maryland?

UN Travel Documents and National Passport

1. ~~The United Nations issues travel documents to facilitate the official travel of its staff members and their eligible dependents. It also provides travel documents to individuals who are not staff members to facilitate their travel and the conduct of the official business for which they have been contracted by the organization to undertake.~~

UN Travel Documents

UN Laissez- Passer

2. ~~The UN Laissez- Passer (UNLP) is issued to staff members of the United Nations under the authority of the Convention on the Privileges and Immunities of the United Nations of 1946 and the Convention on the Privileges and Immunities of the Specialized Agencies of 1947. The Guide to Issuance of United Nations Travel Documents outlines the eligibility, privileges and immunities, application, certification and validity.~~

3. ~~There are no renewals, amendments or inclusions of dependents.~~

UN Family Certificate

4. ~~The UN Family Certificate identifies the bearer as being a family member of the UN official named therein. It is not an official travel document. The Guide to Issuance of United Nations Travel Documents outlines the eligibility, application, certification and validity.~~



UN Certificate

5. The UN Certificate is a document issued to individuals who are not staff members of the United Nations and are travelling on official business on behalf of the organization. It provides limited privileges in accordance with the Convention on Privileges and Immunities of the United Nations. It is not a legal travel document but serves to facilitate the travel on UN business of individuals other than staff members of the UN.
6. The Guide to Issuance of United Nations Travel Documents outlines the eligibility, application, certification and validity.

UN Volunteer (UNV) Identity Card

7. The UN Identity Card serves to identify the bearer as a UN Volunteer. It contains the volunteer's name, agency and country to which he/she is assigned. It is not a travel document.
8. A UN Identity Card is issued to UNVs at the UNDP office in the country of assignment upon submission by the UN Volunteer of UNV Form VI 1/Rev.2, "Application for UN Volunteer Identity Card," and two passport-size photographs.
9. In addition to the UN Volunteer's name, agency and country to which he/she is assigned, the UNV identity card contains the following text in Arabic, Chinese, English, French, Russian and Spanish: "The bearer of this identity card is a UN Volunteer. It is requested that courtesies and facilities be extended to him/her in accordance with his/her special international status as a member of the United Nations Volunteers (UNV) and to facilitate by all suitable means the task in which he/she is engaged."
10. Arrangements must be made by the UNDP Country Office (CO) to have the UNV identity card endorsed by the host government with a similar text in the official language of the country of assignment.
11. The UNV ID card is issued for the exact initial duration of the assignment. Its validity is extended as authorized by the UNV headquarters, in conjunction with any extension of assignment.
12. The names of recognized dependents authorized to join the UN Volunteer at the duty station may be added to the identity card at the discretion of the CO.
13. UNV Identity Cards must be returned to UNV Headquarters on completion of the UN Volunteer's assignment.

Roles and Responsibilities



Type of CertificateResponsible Party(ies)	Validity PeriodResponsibilities	LimitRemarks
Conditional Certificate– Staff Member / Applicant	<u>2 years</u> Report the loss or theft of UNLP immediately to Travel Service Section/GO/BMS, UNTTS and the UN Safety and Security Services; obtain a police report. Staff residing in Country Offices are required to submit a copy of the written report to the UNDP Resident Representative (RR)	<u>2</u> If loss or theft occurred in New York, obtain a report from the UN Security Service in lieu of a police report.
Standard Professional I CertificateUNDP hiring unit / Applicant	<u>5 years</u> Request issuance of UN Certificate for independent contractors and personnel services agreement holders.	<u>1</u>
Standard Professional II Certificate– GSSC	<u>5 years</u> Ensure that separating staff members and staff members on SLWOP return their UNLPs to Travel Service Section for cancellation.	<u>1</u> For internationally recruited staff members
Advanced Professional CertificateCountry Office and other BUs outside of HQs	<u>5 years</u> Ensure that SMs return their UNLPs to OHR who in turn will deliver to Travel Service Section for cancellation.	<u>unlimited</u> For locally recruited staff members

RENEWAL FAQ

How do I renew my Conditional Certificate?

To get a second Conditional Certificate, a teacher must complete a minimum of 12 credits listed on the conditional evaluation and must meet the Maryland qualifying score on Praxis I.

How do I renew my Standard Professional I Certificate?

Complete a total of 6 credits, reading credits if you have not satisfied your requirement, during the five-year validity period. Since you will have a total of ten years to complete your master's degree or master's equivalency, you will probably want to take more than just the 6 required credits. You also must have a minimum of three years of successful teaching experience during the validity period of your certificate.

How do I renew my Standard Professional II Certificate?



By the end of the five-year validity period of your Standard Professional II certificate, you must complete either a master's degree or master's equivalent (*36 credits, 21 must be taken at the graduate level and the remaining 15 can be any combination of undergraduate, graduate, or MSDE credits). You also must have a minimum of three years of successful teaching experience during the validity period of your certificate.

What must I do to renew my Advanced Professional Certificate?

You must complete a total of 6 credits and/or equivalent credits during the five-year validity period of each Advanced Professional Certificate. You also must have a minimum of three years of successful teaching experience during the validity period of each certificate.

What courses are acceptable for certificate renewal?

All coursework must be taken at a regionally accredited college or university or through MSDE and must be related to education in general or your certification area.

What is Equivalent Credit? Can anyone use these credits to renew a certificate?

Equivalent credit is awarded for specified professional development experiences. **APC certificate holders ONLY** may renew their certificates with equivalent credit and/or undergraduate, graduate or MSDE credits. Equivalent credits are specific to CCPS and can only be used to renew an Advanced Professional Certificate. A list of options and other pertinent information is available on the following websites:

Professional Development Plan

Professional Development Activities

Who is responsible for renewing my certificate?

You are responsible for keeping track of your current certificate and its validity period. You need to keep track of the coursework that you complete and be sure to send original transcripts/official grade reports to Human Resources for all coursework completed.

College transcripts and grade reports must be requested by the certificate holder. Human Resources will make a request for your certificate to MSDE about two months before your certificate expires after all official documentation is received for your renewal credits.

You are also now required to log in to your TEACH portal and request renewal.

Is there a fee to renew my certificate? How do I pay it?

There is a \$10 certification renewal fee, but the addition of a certification area costs nothing. The renewal fee will be deducted from your biweekly pay as long as an authorization form is on file.



Certification Fee Authorization Form

ADVANCED PROFESSIONAL CERTIFICATE FAQ

When am I eligible for my Advanced Professional Certificate?

After you have three years of school level teaching, administrative or specialist experience and a master's degree or equivalent ** (see above) you are eligible for the APC Certificate. There is a pay increase associated with the APC certificate so it is advantageous to apply for it as soon as you are eligible.

How do I request the APC?

You can request the APC by requesting a renewal in the TEACH portal. It is not automatically requested unless your current certificate is expiring. The pay increase will go into effect the first day of the month after the request is made and transcripts are received by certification@ccps.org.

When am I eligible for a Master's plus pay increase?

You are eligible for the **Master's plus 30** when you have a conferred master's degree and 30 additional credits. A minimum of 27 credits must be taken at the graduate level and 3 credits can be MSDE credits. You are eligible for the **Master's plus 60** when you have a conferred master's degree and 60 additional credits. A minimum of 54 credits must be taken at the graduate level and 6 credits can be MSDE credits.

How do I request the Master's plus 30/60 pay increase?

You can request the Master's plus 30/60 by emailing certification@ccps.org. It is not automatically requested. The pay increase will go into effect the first day of the month after the request is made.

Other FAQ (adding an endorsement, ancillary credits, senior exemption, and certificate copies)

How may I add a certification area to my certificate?

You may add a teaching certification area by completing 30 credits in a particular certification area or by passing the content praxis test(s) for a specific certification area with a Maryland qualifying score. Please reach out to certification@ccps.org to verify the correct Praxis test for adding an endorsement.

Specialist certifications (Media, Guidance, Reading Specialists, etc.) and Administrator certification require a course by course evaluation or the conferral of a master's degree in the



appropriate area. Evaluations are completed by the Certification Specialist upon request. Please submit a request to certification@ccps.org.

How and when do I get my actual certificate?

Upon renewal your certificate and certification renewal requirements will be emailed to the email address on file in your TEACH portal. You can print your certificate from the MSDE website whenever you wish. To do so, access your TEACH portal at <https://certificationhub.msde.maryland.gov/#/>. You need to set up an account the first time you access the site. After that, you simply need your username and the password you created on the site when you registered.

What is the Senior Teacher Waiver and how do I know if I am eligible for it?

According to COMAR 13A.12.01.14B.(1)(2), a teacher who has 25 years of experience in public education or is 55 years of age may request the Senior Teacher Waiver for certificate renewal. That means that the teacher is exempted from taking the 6 credits to renew his/her certificate and is not held to the reading or special education required courses that have not yet been met. **Senior exemption does not apply to those holding a school counselor or visually impaired certification area.**

TEACH FAQ

What is TEACH?

The **Educator Application and Certification Hub (TEACH)**, is an online portal for educator certification. This portal is mandatory for all Maryland certificate holders.

Do I need to create a portal account?

ALL applicants and certificate holders **MUST** complete a one-time registration by visiting TEACH at <https://certificationhub.msde.maryland.gov/#/> and clicking on the Register button.

Do I need to upload transcripts in TEACH?

No. CCPS Human Resources Office will still collect all transcripts, employment verifications, CPD credit forms, and PDPs. Please send via the pony to the attention of certification or via email to certification@ccps.org.

When do I utilize TEACH?

RENEWAL, ENDORSEMENTS, INITIAL APPLICATIONS

You will now need to request **renewal** of your certificate at the expiration of the validity period. You will receive an email from CCPS Educator Certification 6 months prior to the expiration reminding you to request renewal in the TEACH portal and if any additional credits are needed.

Requesting a new endorsement? You will need to submit a request to certification@ccps.org along with Praxis test scores or transcript AND submit a request in your TEACH account for an endorsement.



New to Maryland or recent graduate? You will need to **register** a portal account and request **INITIAL APPLICATION**.

FOR ADDITIONAL TEACH INFORMATION AND STEP BY STEP INSTRUCTIONS, PLEASE VISIT THE CCPS TEACH WEBSITE AT <https://www.ccps.org/Page/4301>.

For additional information about certification please contact certification@ccps.org
National Passport

14. A national passport is a travel document issued by the government of the country of the staff member's and the dependents' country of citizenship.
15. A valid national passport must be carried along with the UN Laissez-Passer (UNLP) during official business travel. While the UNLP is recognized as an official travel document, it does not take the place of the national passport.
16. Local staff members may claim reimbursement for the issuance of a national passport if required to travel outside of the country on official business travel. The cost of photographs and birth certificates associated with lodging the application may be claimed for reimbursement as well by local staff.

Templates and Forms

- [Form TTS.2-E – Application for issuance of UNLP \(English\)](#)
- [Form TTS.2-E – Application for issuance of UNLP \(French\)](#)
- [Form TTS.7 – UNLP Cancellation](#)
- [Form PT.39-E – Application for UN Family Certificate \(English\)](#)
- [Form PT64-E. Application for UN Certificate \(English\)](#)
- [Template for transmitting requests for travel documents to General Operations](#)
- [Template memo to request for exceptional issuance of Exceptional Red Laissez-Passer \(ERLP\)](#)
- [Standard Operating Procedure – Issuance of United Nations Travel Documents](#)
- [UNDP Security Guide/Clearance UN Travel Advisory and Security Clearance Procedure](#)
- [Medical Clearance](#)